The Golden Whisk Caper

Whodunnit? · Expressions & Equations Name: _____

The Maple Street Bake-Off was in full swing when the oven timer buzzed for the final round. Then the crowd gasped: the **Golden Whisk**, the trophy every baker in town dreams of winning, was missing from its display stand!

Six people were on the fairgrounds, each seen in a different spot, and there are six sneaky ways a trophy could be carried out. You are the lead detective. Find out **who** took it, **where** they were, and **how** they got it away.

How to crack the case

1. Your teacher will post **10 clue cards** around the room. Each card has a math problem and four answer choices. Every choice is paired with a clue.
2. Solve the problem on the **Show Your Work** page. Find your answer among the choices and read the clue next to it. If your answer is not there, check your work.
3. Use the clue to cross out suspects, places or methods on the case board below. Write the card number beside what it cleared.
4. After all 10 cards, exactly one suspect, one place and one method are left. Those three boxes name the culprit. If you end up with none, or more than one, a clue went wrong: recheck your math!

The Suspects	The Places	The Methods
☐ Rosa Alvarez Pastry Champion	☐ Judges' Table	☐ Hidden in a flour sack
☐ Mr. Okafor Head Judge	☐ Frosting Station	☐ Wheeled out in a mixer cart
☐ Ms. Lindqvist Food Critic	☐ Pantry Tent	☐ Baked inside a giant pie
☐ Chef Dmitri Rival Baker	☐ Oven Row	☐ Posed as a cake topper
☐ Tess Brooks Teen Volunteer	☐ Tasting Tent	☐ Stashed in a picnic basket
☐ Grandma June Crowd Favorite	☐ Cooler Truck	☐ Wrapped in a tablecloth

The culprit is _____ **in** _____ **using** _____

Show Your Work

The Golden Whisk Caper · Show every step in the matching box.

Name: _____

1. Choice _____	**2.** Choice _____
3. Choice _____	**4.** Choice _____
5. Choice _____	**6.** Choice _____
7. Choice _____	**8.** Choice _____
9. Choice _____	**10.** Choice _____

Clue #1

The Golden Whisk Caper

Solve:

$$3x - 7 = 8$$

A. $x = 15$	Chef Dmitri was checking his sourdough in Oven Row. Two bakers say he never left the oven door.
B. $x = -5$	Every flour sack was sliced open and sifted. No Whisk, just flour.
C. $x = \frac{1}{3}$	Rosa Alvarez was counting sugar bags in the Pantry Tent. The inventory sheet has her handwriting.
D. $x = 5$	Rosa Alvarez was pulling scones out of the oven in Oven Row while three bakers watched.

Solve the problem, find your answer, and read its clue. Cross it off on your case board.

✂ cut here

Clue #2

The Golden Whisk Caper

Solve:

$$-2x + 5 = 11$$

A. $x = 3$	Chef Dmitri was munching a cookie in the Tasting Tent. A judge jotted down his comments on it.
B. $x = -8$	Mr. Okafor stopped by the Pantry Tent to find a stapler. The volunteer there remembers him.
C. $x = -3$	Security checked every picnic basket at the gate. None held the Whisk.
D. $x = 8$	The flour sacks are all still sealed with their factory stitching, so nothing was hidden inside.

Solve the problem, find your answer, and read its clue. Cross it off on your case board.

Clue #3

The Golden Whisk Caper

Solve:

$$5(x - 1) = 2x + 7$$

A. $x = \frac{12}{7}$	A volunteer poured out the flour sack by the Pantry Tent. Not a single trophy was in it.
B. $x = 4$	Mr. Okafor was scoring entries at the Judges' Table. His score sheets are time-stamped.
C. $x = \frac{8}{3}$	Chef Dmitri was arguing about a score at the Judges' Table. The table monitor remembers every word.
D. $x = -4$	Ms. Lindqvist was interviewing the supply manager in the Pantry Tent. Her recorder was running.

Solve the problem, find your answer, and read its clue. Cross it off on your case board.

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Clue #4

The Golden Whisk Caper

Solve:

$$7x + 4 = 2x - 16$$

A. $x = -\frac{4}{3}$	Tess Brooks was restocking cinnamon in the Pantry Tent all through the final round.
B. $x = 4$	Chef Dmitri was loading ice cream into the Cooler Truck. The driver's clipboard has his name.
C. $x = -\frac{12}{5}$	The flour delivery was weighed on arrival and again after the contest. The totals match exactly.
D. $x = -4$	The mixer cart was weighed and wheeled back empty, so the Whisk never left in it.

Solve the problem, find your answer, and read its clue. Cross it off on your case board.

Clue #5

The Golden Whisk Caper

Solve:

$$\frac{x + 4}{3} = 2$$

A. $x = 6$	Chef Dmitri was decorating cupcakes at the Frosting Station. Sprinkles were still stuck to his sleeve.
B. $x = -2$	A baker dumped the last flour sack into the mixing bowl and saw nothing but flour.
C. $x = 10$	Grandma June was borrowing eggs from the Pantry Tent, and the sign-out clipboard shows her name.
D. $x = 2$	Ms. Lindqvist was sampling pies in the Tasting Tent. Her notebook records every bite.

Solve the problem, find your answer, and read its clue. Cross it off on your case board.

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Clue #6

The Golden Whisk Caper

Solve:

$$-3(x + 2) = 12$$

A. $x = -6$	The giant pie was cut open on stage. Only blueberry filling inside.
B. $x = 2$	A volunteer saw Rosa Alvarez grabbing vanilla in the Pantry Tent just as the timer buzzed.
C. $x = -2$	A food blogger filmed Chef Dmitri tasting jam in the Tasting Tent at the moment the Whisk disappeared.
D. $x = 6$	The flour sacks all still have their original tags, so none was opened and refilled.

Solve the problem, find your answer, and read its clue. Cross it off on your case board.

Clue #7

The Golden Whisk Caper

Solve:

$$3x - 2(x - 4) = 14$$

A. $x = 6$	Tess Brooks was piping frosting at the Frosting Station for a long line of kids.
B. $x = -6$	Mr. Okafor was sharpening pencils for the score sheets in the Pantry Tent. Shavings were still on the floor.
C. $x = 22$	Chef Dmitri was timing his croissants at Oven Row. The oven timer is still set to his batch.
D. $x = 10$	The flour sacks were dusted for fingerprints. The only prints belong to the delivery driver.

Solve the problem, find your answer, and read its clue. Cross it off on your case board.

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Clue #8

The Golden Whisk Caper

Solve:

$$4x + 3 = 6x + 7$$

A. $x = -2$	The topper on the display cake is plastic. The Whisk was not disguised as one.
B. $x = 5$	The cleanup crew emptied every flour sack into the compost bin and found only flour.
C. $x = \frac{2}{5}$	Tess Brooks was stacking paper cups in the Pantry Tent. A photo from 9:15 shows her there.
D. $x = 2$	Chef Dmitri was grabbing butter from the Cooler Truck. The cold-storage log shows his initials.

Solve the problem, find your answer, and read its clue. Cross it off on your case board.

Clue #9

The Golden Whisk Caper

Twice a number plus 9 equals 5 times the number. Write and solve an equation to find the number, x.

A. $x = \frac{9}{5}$	A kid tossed a flour sack around during the pie-eating break. Nothing clunked inside.
B. $x = 3$	Grandma June was handing out lemonade from the Cooler Truck all afternoon.
C. $x = -3$	Chef Dmitri was waiting to talk to the judges at the Judges' Table. Three bakers stood in line behind him.
D. $x = -\frac{9}{7}$	Ms. Lindqvist ducked into the Pantry Tent to escape the sun. The tent guard wrote down the time.

Solve the problem, find your answer, and read its clue. Cross it off on your case board.

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Clue #10

The Golden Whisk Caper

Solve:

$$8 - 3x = 23$$

A. $x = \frac{23}{5}$	Photos from the flour-sack race show every sack flat and floppy. None was hiding a trophy.
B. $x = 5$	Chef Dmitri was fixing a wobbly cake at the Frosting Station. A little girl helped him hold the plate.
C. $x = -5$	Every tablecloth was shaken out and folded. Nothing was wrapped inside.
D. $x = \frac{31}{3}$	Grandma June was hunting for her secret cinnamon in the Pantry Tent when the gasp went up.

Solve the problem, find your answer, and read its clue. Cross it off on your case board.